Writing: A famous person I admire

Day 2 · Writing

What to do: Discuss first (exercise 1), then write in the copybook at home or in class.

Murphy today
Murphy red, Unit 17 (page 45): **17.2** at home. Do the grammar file first.

1 Warm-up: talk before you write (5 minutes, in pairs)

1. Which famous person do you admire most? It can be from history or today.
2. What is this person famous for?
3. Have you ever seen this person, or a film, a book or a place about them?
4. What challenge did this person face? Was it difficult?
5. What did this person contribute to the world?
6. Which qualities does this person have: brave, wise, kind, clever?
7. What have you learned from this person?
8. Would you like to meet this person? What would you ask?

Choose one topic and tell it to your partner. The partner asks one more question for each of the first 3 answers.

2 Useful words

is famous for · was born in · faced a challenge · contributed to · has won · has never… · I admire… because…

Unit 7 words: famous · challenge · contribute · protect · expert · prince · peace · difference

3 The plan: 4 short paragraphs, 120–150 words

1 · Introduction	Who is the person? What is he or she famous for? (present simple)
2 · Body 1	Life: when and where born, what challenge, what happened (past simple).
3 · Body 2	Achievements: what has this person done? Use the present perfect for 2 sentences (has won, has written…).
4 · Conclusion	Why do you admire the person? What can we learn?

Model and your task

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What to do: In the model: the present perfect for the achievements, the past simple for the life.

Ulugh Beg: The Prince Who Loved the Stars

Ulugh Beg is one of the most famous people in the history of Samarkand. He was a prince, a ruler and, above all, a scientist.

He was born in 1394 and he was the grandson of Timur. As a young man he faced a big challenge: to rule a large country. But he also loved astronomy. In the 1420s he built a great observatory and, with his team, he made a catalog of more than 1,000 stars.

His catalog has helped astronomers for hundreds of years. He has contributed more to science than to politics, and scientists around the world have used his work. Sadly, his own son rebelled against him in 1449.

I admire Ulugh Beg because he looked at the sky when many people looked only at power. He teaches us that curiosity can be more important than a crown.

A Choose ONE: a famous person I admire

Write 120–150 words. Follow the plan. Use the present perfect at least 3 times (has won, has written, has never...), the past simple for the life story, and 4 words from Unit 7.

B Or: an interview with a famous person

Write 8 questions and the answers: *Have you ever...? When did you...? What was the biggest challenge? What have you learned?*

Check before you finish

4 paragraphs · present perfect for experience and results · past simple for dates and details · 4 Unit 7 words · capital letters and full stops